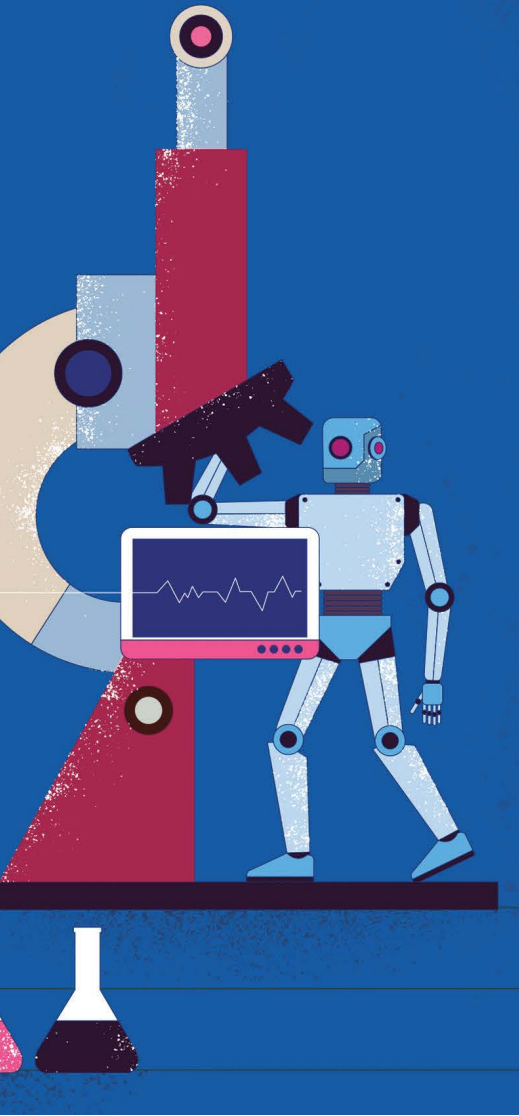




A **PATIENT MAY** receive early warning that he is at the risk of suffering a cardiovascular event after an AI model identifies cardiac patterns that would otherwise have gone undetected.

Another who has undergone a CT scan may never know that AI vetted the images before the radiologist signed the report.

In some hospitals, doctors are spending less time writing discharge summaries because Generative AI (GenAI) has taken over routine documentation.

These represent the first wave of AI applications moving from pilot stage to everyday clinical workflows across India's healthcare system.

Healthcare has always been AI's toughest laboratory. Unlike retail, finance or customer service, where new technologies can be rolled out quickly, medicine demands evidence, accountability and trust before innovation reaches the patient.

After all, a diagnosis or treatment recommendation is not just another algorithmic output; it affects human lives. Before AI can become part of clinical practice, it must first earn the confidence of doctors, hospitals, regulators and, ultimately, patients. The journey is well underway, say healthcare practitioners.

Sangita Reddy, Joint Managing Director of Apollo Hospitals Enterprise Ltd, says the early phase of AI in healthcare was about proving an algorithm works. The challenge now is to make it work safely, consistently and at scale in a live clinical environment. "It is not just about accuracy. The question is if it is clinically useful, trusted by care teams and capable of delivering sustained value," she tells *BT*.

Apollo has already deployed AI in imaging, nursing workflows, discharge summaries, medical coding and remote patient monitoring. "Our investments have evolved accordingly. We now invest as much on electronic medical-record integration, secure infrastructure, governance and clinician adoption as we do on the algorithm itself," says Reddy.

Apollo has developed 20 certified algorithms with 12 in production and eight at different stages of integration and deployment.

BEYOND PILOTS

If there is one clear winner in healthcare's AI journey so far, it is diagnosis. Whether it's analysing

VARIED USE CASES

- **AI is no longer confined to proof-of-concept projects. Hospitals are integrating it into imaging, diagnostics, clinical documentation and patient monitoring**
- **Radiology, pathology, cardiology and genomics are leading AI adoption because they have large volumes of structured data and are facing an acute shortage of specialist expertise**
- **Real returns are being measured through earlier diagnosis, improved clinical outcomes, patient safety, operational efficiency and better utilisation of healthcare resources**
- **Scaling AI requires far more than building models. Healthcare providers are investing heavily in electronic medical records, digital infrastructure, cybersecurity, governance, workflow integration and clinician adoption**
- **AI's future in healthcare will depend as much on robust data governance, regulatory readiness and affordable deployment as on technological innovation**